

College Street Journal

From Venice to MHC: Author Pasinetti to Speak April 18



P. M. Pasinetti will deliver a talk titled "From Venice to LA and Back: Cosmopolitanism, Writing, and Memory" on Tuesday, April 18, in Pratt Hall's Warbeke Room at 7:30 pm.

Novelist, journalist, and professor of comparative literature and Italian at University of California, Los Angeles, P. M. Pasinetti will deliver a talk titled "From Venice to LA and Back: Cosmopolitanism, Writing, and Memory" on Tuesday, April 18, in Pratt Hall's Warbeke

Room at 7:30 pm. The lecture is sponsored by the Five College Italian Seminar and the Mount Holyoke College Department of Spanish and Italian.

Gore Vidal has written of Pasinetti's work: "Venice has had to wait until the twentieth century to claim its own novelist: P. M. Pasinetti. The world he recreates (or perhaps creates) is no less complex than that of Proust, Joyce, or Mann. But his passions are different, and so is the city. Venice is neither Paris, Dublin, or Lubeck, nor is it Calvino's stunning invisibility." A recipient of the Fiction Award of the National Institute of Arts and Letters, Pasinetti is the author of numerous articles, reviews, and film scripts, as well as several novels, including *Venetian Red* (1960), *From the Academy Bridge* (1970), and *Dorsoduro* (1983).

P. M. Pasinetti was born and grew up in Venice. In 1935, he came to study in this country, where his first published fiction appeared in the *Southern Review*. He had been writing pieces for magazines and newspapers in Italy since the age of eighteen. His first book, three novelettes, was published in 1942. After lectureships at Goettingen and Stockholm, where he spent most of the war years, Pasinetti returned to the United States in 1946. He taught briefly at Bennington College before receiving a doctorate in comparative literature (the first ever awarded) from Yale. In 1949, he arrived in Los Angeles to take a position as professor of comparative literature and Italian at UCLA. In 1964, he was appointed to the Institute for Creative Arts at UCLA. Since 1958, he has divided his time between Venice and Beverly Hills.